

File permissions in Linux

Project description

The research team at my organization needs to update the file permissions for certain files and directories within the `projects` directory. The permissions do not currently reflect the level of authorization that should be given. Checking and updating these permissions will help keep their system secure. To complete this task, I performed the following tasks:

Check file and directory details

The following code demonstrates how I used Linux commands to determine the existing permissions set for a specific directory in the file system.

```
researcher2@5d738f0f927b:~/projects$ ls -la
total 32
drwxr-xr-x 3 researcher2 research_team 4096 Dec  2 15:27 .
drwxr-xr-x 3 researcher2 research_team 4096 Dec  2 15:27 ..
-rw--w--- 1 researcher2 research_team  46 Dec  2 15:27 .project_x.txt
drwx--x--- 2 researcher2 research_team 4096 Dec  2 15:27 drafts
-rw-rw-rw- 1 researcher2 research_team  46 Dec  2 15:27 project_k.txt
-rw-r----- 1 researcher2 research_team  46 Dec  2 15:27 project_m.txt
-rw-rw-r-- 1 researcher2 research_team  46 Dec  2 15:27 project_r.txt
-rw-rw-r-- 1 researcher2 research_team  46 Dec  2 15:27 project_t.txt
researcher2@5d738f0f927b:~/projects$
```

The terminal capture illustrates the executed command on the initial line, followed by its generated output. To view the complete inventory of the `projects` directory including hidden items, I executed the `ls` command paired with the `-la` flags. The resulting list reveals five standard project files, one directory named `drafts`, and a concealed file designated as `.project_x.txt`. File access rights are specified by the 10-character permission string visible in the far-left column.

Change file permissions

The following code demonstrates how I used Linux commands to do this:

```
researcher2@5d738f0f927b:~/projects$ chmod o-w project_k.txt
researcher2@5d738f0f927b:~/projects$ ls -la
total 32
drwxr-xr-x 3 researcher2 research_team 4096 Dec  2 15:27 .
drwxr-xr-x 3 researcher2 research_team 4096 Dec  2 15:27 ..
-rw--w--- 1 researcher2 research_team  46 Dec  2 15:27 .project_x.txt
drwx--x-- 2 researcher2 research_team 4096 Dec  2 15:27 drafts
-rw-rw-r-- 1 researcher2 research_team  46 Dec  2 15:27 project_k.txt
-rw-r----- 1 researcher2 research_team  46 Dec  2 15:27 project_m.txt
-rw-rw-r-- 1 researcher2 research_team  46 Dec  2 15:27 project_r.txt
-rw-rw-r-- 1 researcher2 research_team  46 Dec  2 15:27 project_t.txt
researcher2@5d738f0f927b:~/projects$
```

The top two lines of the image capture the sequence of instructions I ran, while the subsequent lines show the output from the final command. I utilized the `chmod` utility to modify file and directory access rights, passing the target permission changes as the first argument and the specific file or directory as the second. Specifically, I stripped the "write" privileges from the "other" user category for `project_k.txt`, afterwards executing `ls -la` to verify that the modifications were successfully applied.

Change file permissions on a hidden file

The following code demonstrates how I used Linux commands to change the permissions:

```
researcher2@3213bbc1d047:~/projects$ chmod u-w,g-w,g+r .project_x.txt
researcher2@3213bbc1d047:~/projects$ ls -la
total 32
drwxr-xr-x 3 researcher2 research_team 4096 Dec 20 15:36 .
drwxr-xr-x 3 researcher2 research_team 4096 Dec 20 15:36 ..
-r--r----- 1 researcher2 research_team  46 Dec 20 15:36 .project_x.txt
drwx--x-- 2 researcher2 research_team 4096 Dec 20 15:36 drafts
-rw-rw-rw- 1 researcher2 research_team  46 Dec 20 15:36 project_k.txt
-rw-r----- 1 researcher2 research_team  46 Dec 20 15:36 project_m.txt
-rw-rw-r-- 1 researcher2 research_team  46 Dec 20 15:36 project_r.txt
-rw-rw-r-- 1 researcher2 research_team  46 Dec 20 15:36 project_t.txt
researcher2@3213bbc1d047:~/projects$
```

In this capture, the first two lines represent my input commands, and the remaining lines detail the output of the final operation. The prefix period in `.project_x.txt` confirms its status as a hidden file. For this file, I revoked write access for both the owner and the group, while simultaneously granting read access to the group. This was

accomplished by combining u-w to strip user write access, g-w to strip group write access, and g+r to assign group read access.

Change directory permissions

The following code demonstrates how I used Linux commands to change the permissions:

```
researcher2@5d738f0f927b:~/projects$ chmod g-x drafts
researcher2@5d738f0f927b:~/projects$ ls -la
total 32
drwxr-xr-x 3 researcher2 research_team 4096 Dec  2 15:27 .
drwxr-xr-x 3 researcher2 research_team 4096 Dec  2 15:27 ..
-r--r----- 1 researcher2 research_team  46 Dec  2 15:27 .project_x.txt
drwx----- 2 researcher2 research_team 4096 Dec  2 15:27 drafts
-rw-rw-r-- 1 researcher2 research_team  46 Dec  2 15:27 project_k.txt
-rw-r----- 1 researcher2 research_team  46 Dec  2 15:27 project_m.txt
-rw-rw-r-- 1 researcher2 research_team  46 Dec  2 15:27 project_r.txt
-rw-rw-r-- 1 researcher2 research_team  46 Dec  2 15:27 project_t.txt
researcher2@5d738f0f927b:~/projects$
```

This output details the specific access privileges assigned to various files and folders. The first two lines reference the current (projects) and parent (home) directories, respectively, while line 3 denotes a standard hidden file named .project_x.txt. Line 4 reveals a restricted directory named drafts, where execute access is strictly limited to the researcher2 account. Because the group account previously held execute privileges that needed to be revoked, I applied the chmod command to remove them; no further action was needed for researcher2, who already retained execute rights.

Summary

To align the projects directory contents with corporate authorization policies, I modified several file and directory access settings. I initiated the process by running ls -la to assess the baseline security postures, which provided the necessary context for my adjustments. Consequently, I executed a series of chmod instructions to systematically update the permissions across the targeted files and folders.